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Musharraf and I

General Pervez Musharraf and I are peers in a curious way, though we have never met. There have been many interesting and some coincidental events in our lives. We were both born in India in the 1940s against the backdrop of the Second World War, when we were still a colony of the British Empire. We came from middle-class families that were on the wrong side of the border when the country was partitioned in 1947. The Musharraf family migrated from Delhi to Karachi, and my ancestors moved in the opposite direction, from Rawalpindi to Patiala. Both families faced untold hardships as refugees or mohajirs as they were called in Pakistan, and still are! The experience of growing up in nascent nations that had fought a war over Kashmir in 1947–48, was shaping our young minds. We joined our respective military academies in 1961, and also got commissioned in the same year – 1964. Adventurous and fond of the outdoors, we have both been fairly skilled marksmen. As youngsters, we fancied Bengali damsels, but unlike Musharraf, mine was a briefer friendship as recounted in Part II.

From what I have read, Musharraf got married in 1968 to Sehba Farid, a pretty and talented young lady. It was an arranged marriage. They have two children, a girl and a boy.

I was also a captain when I was married, albeit in a different fashion. I met and fell in love with an attractive young girl of nineteen at the 'New Year's Eve' dance at the Army Club in Poona. Two months later, we were engaged, and got married in May 1971. We also have two children, a boy and a girl.